COMMITTEE DIRECTOR · PRACTICAL REFERENCE

UNGA
Complete CD Survival Guide

Delegate Questions, Motions, Points, Procedures & Unexpected Situations

IBAD-MUN 2026 | Climate action & cooperation | CD + ACD

Committee: United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)
Agenda: Strengthening Global Action and International Cooperation to Combat Climate Change

PART 1 · Understand Your Authority

As Committee Director, you are responsible for:

1. Opening and closing the committee.
2. Maintaining order and decorum.
3. Recognizing delegates who wish to speak.
4. Conducting formal debate and caucuses.
5. Recognizing motions and points.
6. Managing the speakers' list.
7. Supervising working papers and draft resolutions.
8. Conducting voting procedures.
9. Ensuring equal treatment of all delegations.

Your ACD is responsible for:

1. Recording attendance.
2. Maintaining the speakers' list.
3. Recording motions and points.
4. Managing the timer.
5. Recording voting results.
6. Keeping track of working papers and draft resolutions.
7. Informing you about procedural matters.

> **Important:** The CD makes procedural decisions. The ACD assists and records. The ACD should not independently make decisions on behalf of the Chair.

PART 2 · Basic MUN Terms You Must Know

1. **Delegate:** A participant representing a country.
2. **Dais:** The committee's chairing team, usually including the CD and ACD.
3. **Placard:** The country name card raised by a delegate to request recognition or vote.
4. **Floor:** The right to speak during committee proceedings.
5. **GSL:** General Speakers' List. Delegates deliver formal speeches on the agenda.
6. **Moderated Caucus:** Structured discussion where the Chair recognizes individual speakers for short speeches on a specific topic.
7. **Unmoderated Caucus:** Informal discussion during which delegates move around, negotiate, form blocs, and work on proposals.
8. **Working Paper:** Informal document containing proposed solutions and ideas.
9. **Draft Resolution:** Formal document presenting proposed actions and solutions for committee consideration.
10. **Sponsor:** Country that has substantially contributed to and supports a draft resolution.
11. **Signatory:** Country that wants a draft resolution discussed. Signing does not necessarily mean supporting it.
12. **Amendment:** Proposed change to a draft resolution.
13. **Motion:** Formal proposal made by a delegate to change committee procedure.
14. **Point:** Procedural request or concern raised by a delegate.
15. **Yield:** Way a delegate gives up remaining speaking time, where permitted.

PART 3 · What Delegates Can Ask You

A. Questions About Procedure

1. “Honourable Chair, what is the current agenda?”

Response: “The agenda before this committee is Strengthening Global Action and International Cooperation to Combat Climate Change.”

2. “Can we speak in Urdu?”

Response: “Yes. According to the language policy for this committee, delegates may speak in English, Urdu, or a combination of both.”

3. “How much speaking time do we have?”

Response: “The speaking time for the current session will be announced by the Chair before the debate begins.”

4. “Can I raise my placard?”

Response: “Certainly, delegate. Please raise your placard when you wish to be recognized.”

5. “Can I speak without being recognized?”

Response: “No, delegate. Please wait until the Chair recognizes you before beginning your speech.”

6. “Can I change my country's position?”

Response: “You are representing your assigned country. You may clarify or develop your country's position, but your arguments should remain consistent with its interests and policies.”

B. Questions About Debate

7. “Can I speak again?”

“Yes, delegate, subject to the availability of speaking time and the applicable procedure.”

8. “Can I ask another delegate a question?”

“Questions may be permitted during the designated discussion or question period. Please wait for the Chair's instructions.”

9. “Can I disagree with another country?”

“Certainly. Diplomatic disagreement is part of debate. However, please address the argument respectfully and avoid personal remarks.”

10. “Can I mention another country's policies?”

“Yes, provided your remarks are relevant to the agenda and remain diplomatic.”

11. “Can I criticize another country's position?”

“Delegates may respectfully challenge policies and proposals. Personal attacks and disrespectful language are not acceptable.”

C. Questions About Working Papers

12. “Can we form a bloc?”

“Yes. During the unmoderated caucus, delegates may form groups and negotiate proposals.”

13. “Can countries from different regions work together?”

“Certainly. Any delegation may cooperate with another delegation, regardless of geographical region.”

14. “Can we submit more than one working paper?”

“Please submit your documents to the Dais for review. The committee will process them according to the applicable document-submission procedure.”

15. “Can we add another country's proposal to our working paper?”

“Yes, provided the countries involved agree to the inclusion of that proposal.”

16. “Does signing a working paper mean we support it?”

“Not necessarily. A signature generally indicates willingness for the document to be considered, rather than unconditional support.”

D. Questions About Draft Resolutions

17. “Can we submit a draft resolution without a working paper?”

“Please submit the document to the Dais. Its eligibility will be considered according to the committee's document-submission rules.”

18. “Can we have multiple sponsors?”

“Yes, multiple sponsors are common. The required number and eligibility conditions will follow the conference rules.”

19. “Can a country sign more than one draft resolution?”

“That depends on the applicable document-submission rules. Please confirm the relevant requirements with the Dais.”

20. “Can we change a draft resolution after submission?”

“Changes may be proposed through the applicable amendment procedure. Please submit your proposed changes to the Dais.”

PART 4 · Points — What They Mean and How to Respond

Points are procedural requests, not proposals to change the committee's agenda.

1. Point of Personal Privilege

Purpose: Used when a delegate experiences a personal difficulty that prevents effective participation (cannot hear the speaker, cannot see presentation, room too noisy, or needs reasonable accommodation).

> **DELEGATE**
> “Point of Personal Privilege!”

> **CD**
> “State your point, delegate.”

If the delegate cannot hear:

> **CD**
> “Thank you, delegate. The speaker is requested to speak louder. The Dais will ensure that the committee can hear the proceedings.”

If unrelated to debate: “Thank you, delegate. The Dais will address your concern.” **Note:** This point may sometimes interrupt a speaker if urgent. Follow your RoP.

2. Point of Order

Purpose: Used when a delegate believes committee procedure is not being followed correctly.

> **DELEGATE**
> “Point of Order!”

> **CD**
> “State your point, delegate.”

Example: “Honourable Chair, the speaking time has exceeded the allocated limit.”

> **CD**
> “Thank you for bringing that to the attention of the Dais. The Chair will review the timing and ensure that the procedure is followed.”

For a concern that a motion was mishandled: “Thank you, delegate. The Dais will review the procedural matter and provide clarification.” A Point of Order concerns procedure, not disagreement with another country's speech.

3. Point of Parliamentary Inquiry

Purpose: Used when a delegate wants to ask the Chair about committee procedure.

> **DELEGATE**
> “Point of Parliamentary Inquiry!”

> **CD**
> “State your inquiry, delegate.”

Question: “Can we submit an amendment during the voting procedure?” Response: “Amendments should be submitted and processed according to the committee's amendment procedure. Please submit them before voting begins unless the applicable rules provide otherwise.”

Question: “What happens after the moderated caucus?” Response: “After the moderated caucus concludes, the committee will proceed to the next scheduled activity.” This is not an opportunity to make a speech or debate the agenda.

PART 5 · Motions — The Most Important Procedures

A motion is a formal proposal to change what the committee is doing. Delegate normally raises placard and says “Motion!” You respond: “State your motion, delegate.”

1. Motion to Open the General Speakers' List

Delegate: “Motion to open the General Speakers' List with a speaking time of 45 seconds.”

CD: “Thank you, delegate. The motion has been noted. The Dais will proceed according to the committee's procedure.”

If in order and requiring a vote: “All those in favour, please raise your placards. All those against? Any abstentions, if permitted?” ACD counts; CD announces result. The GSL may also be opened by the Chair without a motion, depending on RoP.

2. Motion for a Moderated Caucus

Delegate: “Motion for a 20-minute moderated caucus on the topic of climate finance, with a speaking time of 45 seconds.”

CD: “Thank you, delegate. The motion is in order, subject to the committee's rules.” Check total duration, topic, and individual speaking time.

If approved: “The motion passes. The committee will now enter a moderated caucus on climate finance for 20 minutes, with 45 seconds allocated to each speaker.” If rejected: “The motion does not pass. The committee will continue with the current proceedings.”

3. Motion for an Unmoderated Caucus

Delegate: “Motion for a 15-minute unmoderated caucus to discuss and prepare working papers.” CD: “Thank you, delegate. The motion has been noted.”

If approved: “The motion passes. The committee will enter a 15-minute unmoderated caucus. Delegates may now begin negotiations and work on their proposals.” If rejected: “The motion does not pass. We will continue with the current session.”

4. Motion to Extend a Caucus

Delegate: “Motion to extend the moderated caucus by five minutes.” CD: “Thank you, delegate. The Chair will consider the motion according to the committee's procedural rules.”

If approved: “The motion passes. The caucus is extended by five minutes.” If rejected: “The motion does not pass. We will proceed according to the original schedule.”

5. Motion to Introduce a Draft Resolution

Delegate: “Motion to introduce Draft Resolution 1.1.” CD: “Thank you, delegate. The Dais will verify the document's eligibility. If it meets the applicable requirements, it will be introduced to the committee.”

6. Motion to Enter Voting Procedure

Delegate: “Motion to enter voting procedure.” CD: “Thank you, delegate. The Chair will consider this motion in accordance with the committee's rules and the scheduled proceedings.”

If approved: “The committee will now enter voting procedure. All delegates are requested to remain silent and follow the Chair's instructions.”

7. Motion to Adjourn the Meeting

Delegate: “Motion to adjourn the meeting.” CD: “Thank you, delegate. The motion will be considered according to the applicable procedure and the committee schedule.”

> Adjournment means ending the committee session. Do not confuse it with suspending the meeting for a break.

PART 6 · How to Handle Common Delegate Behaviour

1. Nobody raises a placard

> **CD**
> “The floor is open to the committee. Are there any delegates wishing to speak?”

Wait a few seconds. If nobody responds: “The Dais will proceed to the next scheduled activity.”

2. Too many delegates raise placards

“The Dais recognizes the delegation of [COUNTRY].” ACD records the country. Do not select based on personal preference; give fair opportunities.

3. Delegate speaks without recognition

“Delegate, kindly wait until you have been recognized by the Chair.” If continued: “Delegate, the Chair requests that you respect the proceedings and allow the recognized speaker to continue.”

4. Two delegates argue

“Honourable delegates, please maintain diplomatic decorum. This committee is a platform for constructive debate, not personal confrontation.” If continued: “The Chair requests both delegations to return to the agenda and address their concerns through diplomatic language.”

5. Irrelevant speech

“Delegate, kindly keep your remarks relevant to the agenda under discussion.”

6. Delegate exceeds speaking time

“Delegate, your speaking time has elapsed. Kindly conclude your remarks.” If continued: “The Chair requests the delegate to yield the floor.”

7. Delegate insults another country

“Delegate, please maintain diplomatic language. You may challenge a country's policy, but personal or disrespectful remarks are not acceptable.”

8. Delegate refuses instructions

“The Chair has already issued an instruction. The delegate is requested to comply with the committee's rules.” If behaviour continues, follow conference disciplinary procedure and inform Secretariat if necessary.

9. Delegate arrives late

“Welcome, delegate. Please take your seat quietly. The ACD will update the attendance record.” Do not automatically exclude from participation; follow attendance and voting rules.

10. Delegate leaves the room

ACD records departure if required. On return: “Welcome back, delegate. Please take your seat.”

PART 7 · Moderated Caucus — What You Must Do

Before starting, announce **topic, total duration, speaking time**, and that delegates should raise placards for recognition.

> **EXAMPLE ANNOUNCEMENT**
> "The committee will now enter a moderated caucus on the impact of climate change on developing countries. The total duration is 20 minutes, with 45 seconds allocated to each speaker."

During the caucus:

- Recognize one delegate at a time.
- Let the delegate speak.
- Monitor speaking time.
- Ask the next recognized delegate to speak.
- Keep discussion relevant.
- Maintain a record of important proposals.

If a delegate asks a question during another speech: "Please wait until the speaker has concluded. The Chair will entertain procedural requests afterward."

PART 8 · Unmoderated Caucus — What You Must Do

Delegates may move around the committee room, discuss national positions, form blocs, negotiate, share proposals, prepare working papers, combine ideas, and find sponsors and signatories.

Your responsibility: Announce beginning and ending time; monitor room; ensure respectful conduct; remind delegates of remaining time; ensure documents are submitted properly.

> **USEFUL ANNOUNCEMENTS**
> "Delegates, the unmoderated caucus has officially begun."
>
> "Delegates, five minutes remain. Please begin finalizing your proposals."
>
> "One minute remains. Kindly prepare to return to your seats."
>
> "The unmoderated caucus has concluded. All delegates are requested to return to their seats."

PART 9 · Working Papers and Draft Resolutions

Working Paper

A working paper is an informal collection of ideas; it does not automatically become an official resolution.

> **UPON SUBMISSION**
> "Thank you, delegate. The Dais has received your working paper. It will be reviewed for clarity and relevance."

Check agenda relevance, clarity of proposals, identified countries, and organization.

Draft Resolution

A formal proposal containing solutions for committee consideration. Typical structure: heading; preambulatory clauses; operative clauses; sponsors; signatories. Preambulatory clauses explain background and concerns; operative clauses present proposed actions.

Question: "Can we submit a draft resolution?" Response: "Yes. Please submit it to the Dais for review according to the applicable submission requirements."

When approved for introduction: "The Dais has reviewed Draft Resolution [NUMBER]. The document is approved for introduction under the committee's applicable procedure."

PART 10 · Amendments

An amendment is a proposal to change a draft resolution: adding/removing a clause, changing wording, or modifying a proposal.

Original: “Encourages countries to adopt renewable energy sources.”

Proposed: “Encourages countries to adopt renewable energy sources, with international financial and technical assistance for developing nations.”

> **WHEN SUBMITTED**
> “Thank you, delegate. Please provide the exact clause number and proposed wording.”

Check the draft resolution, clause, amendment type, original wording, proposed wording, and proposing country.

Friendly amendment: Proposed change accepted by relevant sponsors under conference rules.

Unfriendly amendment: Proposed change not accepted as friendly and may require formal consideration and voting.

> Do not assume every amendment automatically passes.

PART 11 · Voting Procedure

> **BEFORE VOTING**
> “The committee will now enter voting procedure. All delegates are requested to remain silent.”

Confirm the resolution; explain voting method; follow approved voting rules; collect placard or roll-call votes as applicable; ACD records every vote; verify totals before announcement.

“Can we abstain?” — “Abstentions will be handled according to the committee's voting rules.”

“Can we change our vote?” — “Once a vote has been recorded, changes will only be considered if permitted by the applicable voting procedure.”

“Can we speak during voting?” — “The committee is currently in voting procedure. Delegates are requested to remain silent unless the Chair permits a procedural point.”

If passed: “Draft Resolution [NUMBER] has received the required votes and is hereby adopted by the committee.”

If rejected: “Draft Resolution [NUMBER] has not received the required votes and is therefore not adopted.”

> **Important:** Never announce adoption until the ACD has verified the count and you have confirmed the required voting threshold.

PART 12 · Questions That May Confuse You

“Can a delegate vote against their own country's bloc?”

> **RESPONSE**
> “Each delegation is responsible for casting its own vote according to the applicable voting procedure.”

“Can we change our sponsor?”

> **RESPONSE**
> “Please submit the requested change to the Dais. It will be processed according to the document rules.”

> **Source text ends here:** The supplied text stops immediately after the opening quote for the next question (“## “). No additional questions or answers were provided, so none have been added.

Chair’s guiding principle
Remain impartial, apply the official Rules of Procedure, give delegations fair treatment, and consult the ACD and Secretariat when a procedure is unclear.